

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Daniella Marie A. Leonud
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	MY GIT
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	August 8, 2026
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a}

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copy-paste the original prompt.

First of all, honestly, this challenge was hard for me to do. In this challenge called **MY GIT**, I was asked to work with a Git server. The goal was to make the server believe that I was the root user, create a change, and push it back to the server. At first, I was confused because I did not understand how Git identifies a user or how I could push something as root. I also encountered some errors while trying to figure out the correct commands, so I had to ask Gemini AI to guide me step-by-step.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

First, I read the instructions and hint. I copied the git clone and clicked "Open in Workspace". When I went inside the folder and checked the files, I saw **README.md**. I opened it using `cat README.md`. The message inside said *"Only flag.txt pushed by root:root@picoctf will be updated with the flag."*. I got confused here because I did not know how to "push as root" or what commands to use next. Since I couldn't understand anything and kept getting errors, I had to ask Gemini AI to help me step-by-step.

3. Tools and Commands Used

List every tool/command you used, in the order you used them, and what each one told you.

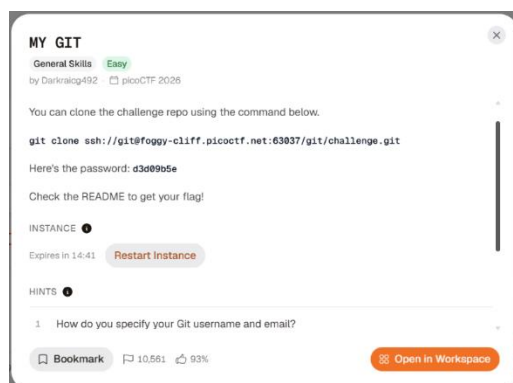
Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
rm -rf challenge	Removed the broken old folder when I got stuck and restarted.	Cleaned up the workspace.
git clone	Cloned the repository from the server.	Downloaded the challenge folder.
cd challenge	Moved inside the project folder.	Opened the Git directory.
cat README.md	Read the instructions file.	Told me I need to be root:root@picoctf.
git config	Changed my local Git name and email.	Set my identity to root and root@picoctf.
echo & git add	Created flag.txt and prepared it to be saved.	Created and staged flag.txt.
git commit	Saved the changes with a message.	Made a commit under the root account.
git push	Sent the changes back to the server.	The server checked my details and gave me the flag!
Gemini AI	Assisted me throughout the whole process when I was confused and lost.	Gave me exact commands to type one by one.

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

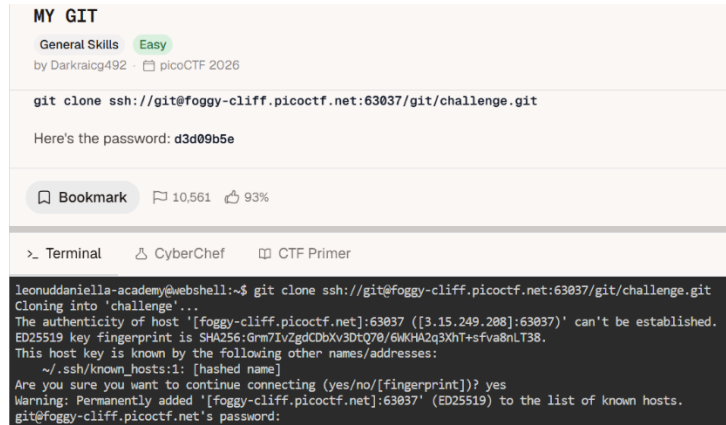
Step 1

I first opened the **MY GIT** challenge and read the instructions and hint carefully. I noticed that the challenge gave me a Git repository that I needed to work with. I copied the provided Git clone command and run it in the terminal.



Step 2

I pasted the Git clone command into the terminal. The command started downloading the repository from the challenge server. During the process, Git asked me to confirm the server fingerprint, so I typed **yes**. After that, it asked for the password that was provided by the challenge, so I entered **d3d09b5e**. The repository was then successfully cloned into my workspace.

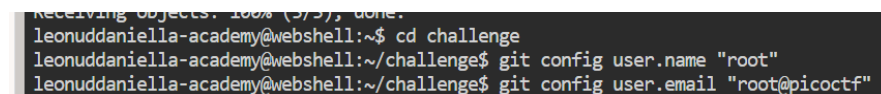


The screenshot shows a web interface for a challenge titled "MY GIT". It includes a "General Skills" section with a "Easy" badge, a "by Darkraio492" credit, and a "picoCTF 2026" tag. The main content area displays the command `git clone ssh://git@foggy-cliff.picoctf.net:63037/git/challenge.git` and a note: "Here's the password: d3d09b5e". Below this are a "Bookmark" button, a "10,561" view count, and a "93%" rating. At the bottom, there are tabs for "Terminal", "CyberChef", and "CTF Primer". The "Terminal" tab is active, showing a terminal session where the clone command is executed. The output shows the cloning process, a warning about the host's fingerprint, and a confirmation to add the host to the known hosts list. The password is then entered.

```
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ git clone ssh://git@foggy-cliff.picoctf.net:63037/git/challenge.git
Cloning into 'challenge'...
The authenticity of host '[foggy-cliff.picoctf.net]:63037 ([3.15.249.208]:63037)' can't be established.
ED25519 key fingerprint is SHA256:Grm7IvZgdCDbXv3DtQ70/6WkHA2q3XhT+sfva8nLT38.
This host key is known by the following other names/addresses:
  ~/.ssh/known_hosts:1: [hashed name]
Are you sure you want to continue connecting (yes/no/[fingerprint])? yes
Warning: Permanently added '[foggy-cliff.picoctf.net]:63037' (ED25519) to the list of known hosts.
git@foggy-cliff.picoctf.net's password:
```

Step 3

I entered the folder by typing **cd challenge**. Then I ran **cat README.md** to see what to do. The file said I needed to push a file as **root:root@picoctf**. I did not know how to do that, so I asked Gemini AI for help. Following the AI's guidance, I changed my Git username and email so the server would think I am the root user:

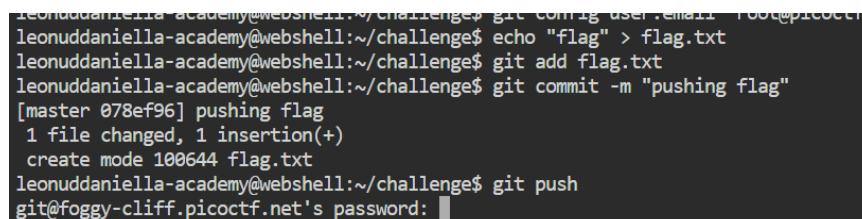


The screenshot shows a terminal session where the user navigates to the 'challenge' directory and configures their Git identity to 'root' with email 'root@picoctf'. The terminal output shows the directory change, the configuration of the username and email, and the start of a push operation.

```
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ cd challenge
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git config user.name "root"
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git config user.email "root@picoctf"
```

Step 4

Next, I created the flag.txt file and added it using these two commands (**echo "flag" > flag.txt & git add flag.txt**), and I committed the file with a simple message (**git commit -m "pushing flag"**). After that, I pushed it back to the server and typed the password again.



The screenshot shows a terminal session where the user creates a file 'flag.txt' with the content 'flag', adds it to the Git index, commits it with the message 'pushing flag', and pushes it to the remote repository. The terminal output shows the file creation, the addition to the index, the commit message, and the push operation. The password is then entered.

```
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git config user.email "root@picoctf"
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ echo "flag" > flag.txt
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git add flag.txt
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git commit -m "pushing flag"
[master 078ef96] pushing flag
1 file changed, 1 insertion(+)
create mode 100644 flag.txt
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~/challenge$ git push
git@foggy-cliff.picoctf.net's password:
```

Step 5

The Git server then checked the commit. Since the commit had the required root username and **root@picoctf** email, the server accepted it. After the push was successful, the server printed the flag in the terminal.

```
Enumerating objects: 4, done.
Counting objects: 100% (4/4), done.
Delta compression using up to 2 threads
Compressing objects: 100% (2/2), done.
Writing objects: 100% (3/3), 269 bytes | 269.00 KiB/s, done.
Total 3 (delta 0), reused 0 (delta 0), pack-reused 0
remote: Author matched and flag.txt found in commit...
remote: Congratulations! You have successfully impersonated the root user
remote: Here's your flag: picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a}
To ssh://foggy-cliff.picoctf.net:63037/git/challenge.git
2001d2f..078ef96 master -> master
```

Step 6

I copied the flag from the terminal and pasted it into the submission box. I submitted the flag, and the challenge accepted it. This confirmed that I had completed the MY GIT challenge.

MY GIT

General Skills Easy

by Darkraicg492 - picoCTF 2026

1 Reveal hint

FLAG

picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a} Submit

Correct flag!

5. Flag

```
picoCTF{1mp3rs0n4t4_g17_345y_6877715a}
```

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

I learned that Git allows anyone to change their username and email locally using simple git configuration commands. Because of this, a server can easily be tricked if it only checks the name attached to a commit. I also learned how to properly clone, commit, and push files using the Linux terminal with an AI assistance.

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

Git Documentation (<https://git-scm.com/docs>)

Gemini AI Assistance (<https://gemini.google.com/>)